

Developing El Niño becomes strongest on record weeks before expected peak

厄尔尼诺现象持续发展，距预估峰值仍有数周便创下历史最强记录

The developing El Niño climate phenomenon is now the strongest on record, according to scientists monitoring Pacific Ocean temperatures.

据监测太平洋温度的科学家称，正在形成的厄尔尼诺气候现象目前已达到有记录以来的最强水平。

Scientists say the developing El Niño is already the strongest ever recorded, with sea temperatures in a **key region** of the Pacific more than three degrees above average, and this event is not expected to **peak** until later this year.

科学家表示，目前正在形成的厄尔尼诺现象已达到有记录以来最强水平，太平洋重点海域的海水温度比平均温度高出3摄氏度以上，次轮厄尔尼诺现象预计要到今年晚些时候才会达到峰值。

El Niño is a natural climate **phenomenon** that **occurs** when unusually warm water develops across the tropical Pacific, **disrupting** weather **patterns** around the world. 厄尔尼诺是一种自然气候现象，当热带太平洋海域的海水出现异常偏暖的情况时便会发生，扰乱全球各地的天气模式。

The Met Office says its impacts are already being felt, with **wildfires** in Indonesia and low water levels in the Panama Canal **restricting** international shipping. As it

develops, it's expected to bring **droughts** and wildfires to parts of Australia, South America and southern Africa, while **coastal** Peru and Ecuador **face** the **threat** of **torrential** rain and **flooding**.

英国气象局表示，厄尔尼诺现象的影响已开始显现，印度尼西亚发生野火，巴拿马运河水位偏低，导致国际货物运输受限。随着该现象的进一步发展，预计澳大利亚、南美洲和南部非洲部分地区将遭遇干旱和野火。与此同时，秘鲁沿海地区和厄瓜多尔则将面临暴雨和洪水带来的威胁。

词汇表

key	关键的；重点的
region	地区；区域
peak	达到峰值
phenomenon	现象
occurs	发生；出现
disrupting	扰乱
patterns	模式；规律
wildfires	野火；自然环境中发生的大规模火灾
restricting	限制
droughts	干旱；旱灾
coastal	沿海的
face	面临

threat	威胁
torrential	倾泻的；倾盆的
flooding	洪水

听力练习（答案见下页）

一、听第一遍音频，回答问题。

1. What's the main idea of the text?

二、用一分钟阅读下列问题，然后听第二遍音频并回答问题。

- Scientists say the developing El Niño is the strongest ever recorded.
 - True
 - False
 - Not given
- El Niño is expected to reach its peak before the end of the year.
 - True
 - False
 - Not given
- What happens during El Niño?
 - Unusually warm water develops across the tropical Pacific.
 - Ocean temperatures fall across the Pacific.
 - Strong winds develop only around Australia.
- Low water levels in the Panama Canal are affecting international shipping.
 - True
 - False
 - Not given
- Which areas are expected to face torrential rain and flooding?
 - Australia and southern Africa
 - Coastal Peru and Ecuador
 - Indonesia and the Panama Canal

三、听第三遍音频，将句子补充完整。（提示：可以反复听，直到听清楚每一个词）

1. Scientists say the developing El Niño is already the strongest ever recorded, with sea temperatures in a key region of the Pacific more than three degrees _____, and this event is not expected to peak until later this year.
2. The Met Office says its impacts _____ felt, with wildfires in Indonesia and low water levels in the Panama Canal restricting international shipping as it develops.

答案

一、听第一遍音频，回答问题。

This article is about how El Niño is already causing unusually warm Pacific waters and is affecting weather and international shipping.

二、用一分钟阅读下列问题，然后听第二遍音频并回答问题。

1. **a. True.** *Scientists say the developing El Nino is **already the strongest ever recorded**.*
2. **b. False.** *This event is not expected to peak **until later this year**.*
3. **a.** *El Niño is a natural climate phenomenon that occurs when **unusually warm water develops across the tropical Pacific**, disrupting weather patterns around the world.*
4. **a. True.** *The Met Office says its impacts are already being felt, with wildfires in Indonesia and **low water levels in the Panama Canal restricting international shipping** as it develops.*
5. **b.** *Coastal **Peru and Ecuador** face the threat of torrential rain and flooding.*

三、听第三遍音频，将句子补充完整。（提示：可以反复听，直到听清楚每一个词）

1. Scientists say the developing El Niño is already the strongest ever recorded, with sea temperatures in a key region of the Pacific more than three degrees **above average** and this event is not expected to peak until later this year.
2. The Met Office says its impacts **are already being** felt, with wildfires in Indonesia and low water levels in the Panama Canal restricting international shipping as it develops.